

69.6 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTED SPEECH IN DIFFERENT TENSES

The tense in reported speech is usually one tense back in time from the tense in direct speech.

I'm working in New York.

PRESENT CONTINUOUS

She said **she was working** in New York.

PAST CONTINUOUS

I've been to China twice.

PRESENT PERFECT

He said that **he'd been** to China twice.

PAST PERFECT

I will call you soon.

FUTURE WITH "WILL"

He said **he would call** them soon.

MODAL VERB "WOULD"

We can speak Japanese.

MODAL VERB "CAN"

They said that **they could speak** Japanese.

MODAL VERB "COULD"



69.7 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTED SPEECH AND THE PAST SIMPLE

The past simple in direct speech can either stay as the past simple or change to the past perfect in reported speech. The meaning is the same.

I arrived in Delhi on Saturday.

DIRECT SPEECH
WITH PAST SIMPLE

He said **he arrived** in Delhi on Saturday.
He said **he'd arrived** in Delhi on Saturday.

REPORTED SPEECH WITH
PAST SIMPLE OR PAST PERFECT

